

Paper Checklist / Guidelines

Citations: References are sufficient in content, quality, and quantity (10-20+) to adequately frame the investigation and are primarily from peer-reviewed empirical oriented journal publications, conference proceedings, and academic books. Trade magazines and/or web/independent articles (i.e., non-peer reviewed) are used only where appropriate. Are presented in numerical sequence using brackets [x] and span the entire document where appropriate.

Rhetoric: Written in 3rd person past tense using objective scientific language. An argument for or against the null hypothesis is articulated. All supported arguments are logical and relevant to the hypotheses and focus of the study. The argument(s) made in the paper is/are supported by the results, historical references, and statistically valid observations.

Grammar: Sentences flow smoothly and wording is varied with minimal redundancy. Relationships between paragraphs is discernible (i.e., one idea/theme runs through each paragraph). Spelling, mechanics, punctuation, and capitalization mistakes are minimized. Sentence structure is correct and conveys intended meaning without undue wordiness.

Formatting: The correct submission format for the paper is used.

Rubric Descriptor (Qualitative)	Content Checklist (Quantitative)*
1) Title: Succinct and describes the experiment. The title should describe the experimental type and focus of the paper, for example, "ABX Discrimination of MP3 Codecs Using Inexpensive Ear-Buds"	○ Describes the experiment. ○ Includes the focus, test design, and conditions.
2) Introduction: Explains the focus and why the experiment is needed. Summarizes the key <i>findings</i> and <i>limits</i> of prior research.	○ A single sentence describing the focus of the study. ○ Summarize all studies that set the context for this study. Include both those that agree/support and those that oppose/are contrary. ○ A sentence stating the experimental research question of this study. ○ Section closes with explanations of how results might apply to audio engineering, music production, or technology improvement/development.
3) Hypothesis: Contains a testable statement with a null-prediction of the results of the experiment.	○ Start this section with the null hypothesis statement. ○ Describe the independent and dependent variables. ○ State the measure used to quantify each dependent variable. ○ Explain how the stimuli were created for the experiment. ○ Describe the listening test procedures. ○ State the number of trials for each test condition. ○ Describe the subjects' general characteristics (e.g., college age, audio engineering students, etc.). ○ Summarize a related experimental design. ○ State what the subjects were asked to do. ○ State how many trials each subject completed during the experiment.
4) Research Design: Explains the details of the experimental procedures. Should contain all of the information needed for another investigator to replicate the experiment (i.e., stimulus, listening conditions, subjects, tasks, etc.).	

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5) Results: Describes the results of the experiment in a logical order. Uses reporting syntax and lexicon properly (e.g., “50% performance is referred to as “chance” performance). Mentions probability of significance, standard deviations, etc. Charts/tables etc. are detailed in the text and include descriptive titles.	○ Describe the raw data in quantitative terms. ○ Summarize the statistics (means, SD, and n for each dependent variable). ○ Include a table, chart or graph depicting a summary of the data. ○ Label charts in sequence as figure 1, figure 2, etc. ○ Include a description of what is shown in chart, graph, tables. ○ Summarize how the statistical metrics were obtained (p-, t-, F-, or r^2- values and state whether or not the results were statistically significant. ○ A sentence stating whether or not the results of the experiment support or reject the null hypothesis.
6) Discussion: Uses the results to build an argument for or against the null hypothesis of the study.	○ At the opening, restate the research question. ○ Describe whether or not the results support or contradict previous citations. ○ Explain how the results answer the research question. ○ Explain what the results suggest about the perception of audio, the performance of the equipment, and the state of understanding.
7) Conclusion: Contains a summary of the key components of the experiment along with how the findings may have practical applications.	○ Describe how the findings from this experiment might be realistically applied to audio engineering, music production, or the improvement of equipment design.
8) Future Research: Connects this investigation to possible future experiments that may enhance the knowledge found in this experiment. Addresses how the experiment might be improved or expanded.	○ Describe the focus of the experiment. ○ Describe the limitations of the design. ○ Include a few suggestions for how the experiment might be improved or continued with more research.

**these are minimum criteria*